CE Training

CE Baseline Assessment tests your listening, reading, speaking, and writing skills, the four pillars for effective communication. It contains nine sections, and you are required to complete the assessment within 55 minutes. This guide will provide a comprehensive view of what you can expect in the test and provide tips to develop useful strategies.

1. Read Aloud (2)

This section has two questions that you must complete in two minutes. Read a passage aloud for 30 seconds.

Skills assessed: Speaking and reading

- Be loud and clear
- Speak naturally
- Change your intonation to express the meaning of the sentences. Don't sound like a robot. For example, think about which words to stress and where to pause.
- Focus on pronunciation
- Do not rush
- Enunciate each word clearly (Not a speed reading test)
- Do not have to shout
- Use your normal voice
- Pause and stress for effect
- Maintain a consistent rate of speech
- Do not change or skip words

* In case you are unable to finish the passage in 30 seconds, it will not be counted against you.

Sample Exercise:

A. Domestication is an evolutionary, rather than a political, development. They were more likely to survive and prosper in an alliance with humans than on their own. Humans provided the animals with food and protection, in exchange for which the animals provided the humans their milk and eggs and their flesh.

B. A shirt, tie and blazer may not be the ingredients for our favorite outfit. All wouldn't throw away the idea of school uniform. It is a badge of pride, creates an identity for a school. Male uniforms are typically a white shirt, tie, and Grey pant while female uniforms are typically white blouse and tartan skirt. Dress for summers and winters is also different in some schools. Traditional uniforms may differ from state to state and from country to country.

C. Trade unions originated in Europe during the industrial revolution. Because of the machinery that had become commonplace, skilled labor became less in demand so employers had nearly all of the bargaining power. Employers mistreated the workers and paid them too little for the work they did. Trade unions were organized that would help in the improvement of working conditions.

2. Repeat (16)

This section has 16 questions that you must finish within five minutes.

Skills assessed: Speaking

- Measures your mastery of the phrase and sentence structure
- Repeat each sentence as you hear it. Even if you miss the sentence, just repeat what you have heard even if it's the last two words
- Focus on fluency and pronunciation
- Repeat what you heard using the same voice and tone (e.g., try to use the same rhythm, pauses and intonation) that you heard in the recording.
- Sound natural
- Clearly articulate words

Sample Exercise:

A. Let's meet again in two weeks.
B. Leave town on the next train.
C. Come to my office after class if you need help.

Check this link for more practice questions [PTE Academic Speaking test - repeat a sentence (examenglish.com)]

3. Sentence builds

There are 12 questions and you have three minutes to answer. In this section you will have to listen to group of phrases of words in random order and rearrange them to make a sentence.

Skill assessed: Speaking

- Listen carefully to the phrases
- Consider what they mean and decide how they should be arranged.
- Assess your pronunciation and sentence mastery
- Speak slowly and have a consistent rate of speech

Sample Exercise:

A. any pictures, of your family, do you have
B. next year, to propose, he is planning
C. was reading, my mother, her favorite magazine
D. Has been repaired, by the daughter, her computer
E. Do, you, how do
F. Was done over, his shop, by a street gang
G. In the washing machine, my new dress, fell apart
H. Turn the music up, can you, up
I. In ten minutes, finishes, the download
J. Cooking tonight, I don't, feel

4. Conversations

There are 12 questions and two minutes assigned for this section.

Skill assessed: Listening

- Listen carefully to the conversation and what is being said.
- Consider what the question is asking.
- Provide a short, clear answer.
- Try to understand the message discussed
- Answer in complete sentences

Sample Exercise

Speaker 1: Lucy, can you come to the office early tomorrow

Speaker 2: Sure, what time?

Speaker 3: 7:30 would be great

Question: What will Lucy have to do tomorrow morning?

Sandra and Paul are at a steak restaurant. A waiter greets them.

"Do you know what you would like to drink?" the waiter asks.

"Water and orange juice," Sandra says.

"Thank you. Here are your menus," the waiter says.

The waiter brings water for Paul and orange juice for Sandra.

Question: What kind of restaurant did Paul and Sandra go to?

Speaker 1: Congratulation on graduating with flying colors

Speaker 2: Thanks

Speaker 1: You deserve a party

Question: Why does the person deserve a party?

Speaker1: Why are you shifting your house

Speaker 2: The old place was too far from my office and expensive

Speaker 1: But isn't the new place expensive as well

Speaker 2: Yes, but it has a proper gym and pool

Question: Why did is the person moving to a different house?

5. Typing

This section contains only one question which you must complete in one minute.

Skill assessed: Typing

- Measures your typing speed
- Type quickly and accurately
- Be mindful of spelling mistakes
- Get it right the first time and avoid using backspace/delete keys
- Write exactly what you see including punctuations
- Your work will be saved automatically

6. Sentence Completion

You get 20 questions and eight minutes to complete this section

Skill assessed: Reading

- Choose the most appropriate word (one word only) that aligns with the sentence
- Think of the context
- Look for clues to the correct response in the question
- Follow grammar rules
- You will have 25 seconds to complete each sentence

Sample Exercise

- If you want a hard-working employee, I highly ___ that you hire him
- If you want to meet with the CEO, you need to make an appointment weeks in ___

- The man __ his care key and spent an hour looking for them in the morning
- The amount of air pollution in this town has increased substantially ___ the factory opened
- The company ___ its target last year and reported a profit

7. Dictation

In this section you get seven minutes to answer 16 questions. Listen to a sentence and then type exactly as you heard it.

Skill assessed: Listening

- Write the sentence exactly as you hear it
- Focus on spelling and punctuation
- Be attentive
- Use punctuation marks whenever necessary (add comma for pauses)
- Be mindful of contractions (two or more words combined in a shortened form, usually with an apostrophe, such as can't or I've)
- You will have 25 seconds to complete write each sentence

8. Passage reconstruction

You have three questions and six minutes to complete this section. Read a short paragraph for 30 seconds, after which the passage disappears, you get 90 seconds to reconstruct it.

Skill assessed: Writing

- Make sure you understand the passage.
- Use your own words.
- Do not try to memorize all the words on the screen
- Rewrite in your own words
- Do not write a quick summary – include all the details you can.
- Pay attention to spelling, punctuation, and capitalization.
- Write in complete grammatical sentences.
- Avoid redundancy
- Condense it as much as possible

9. Summary and Opinion

You have one question and 18 minutes to complete this final section. Read a passage and write the author's opinion in 25-50 words. You will also have to write your opinion in minimum 50 words.

Skills assessed: Reading and writing

- Analyze the writer's opinion
- Find the statement that contains reasons to justify the point the writer is trying to make
- Identify the key message in the passage
- Distinguish between fact and opinion
- State your opinion (you agree or disagree with the author) clearly and provide logical reasons
- Do not copy sentences from the paragraph, use your own ideas
- Use simple sentences, correct grammar and spellings

Click on this link to download the CE Baseline assessment help application

*Professionals are allowed to test for individual skills. The score from individual skills test is updated in the above grid to compute the new 'Total Score'. Only the scores of the skills tested are replaced and all other scores from the previous attempt are retained.